A-A-51612A
12 March 1987
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051612(DM)
11 August 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL
(Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers absorbable surgical sutures fabricated of glycolide-lactide copolymer and suitable for use in various surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

Sutures shall be fabricated from braided filaments of glycolide-lactide copolymer. Sutures shall also have a coating of a mixture of 50 percent glycolide-lactide copolymer and 50 percent calcium stearate. Sutures shall be dyed violet and meet the requirements of the USP for extractable color. Sutures which are armed shall be swaged to eyeless needles and meet the requirements of the USP for security of needle attachment. Suture tensile strength shall also be in accordance with the USP.

Needles shall be fabricated from type 420 or 440 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM F899. Needles shall be properly stress-relieved and passivated. Needles shall meet the requirements of ASTM E290 for ductility.

Sutures and needles shall have dimensions as specified in Table I.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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TABLE I. Dimensions

NSN 6515-01	Diameter Min/Max (Mil)	Suture Length (in)	No. of Arms	Needle Circle	Needle Point	Needle Length (in)	Wire Dia. (in)	No. of sut./ packet
231-3635	2.5 3.1	18	2	3/8	Spatula	0.260	0.008	1
231-7236	7.5 8.5	27	1	1/2	Taper	0.859	0.017	1
230-3079	9.5 10.5	27	1	1/2	Taper	0.858	0.022	1
237-0530	7.5 8.5	27	1	1/2	Taper	1.019	0.022	1
231-8123	12.5 13.5	27	1	1/2	Taper	2.750	0.039	1
233-1888	15.4 16.6	27	1	1/2	Taper	2.750	0.039	1
231-3636	12.5 13.5	18	1	1/2	Taper	1.571	0.044	1
233-1887	15.4 16.6	18	1	1/2	Taper	1.890	0.050	1
153-5898	3.5 4.2	18	2	1/4	Spatula	0.335	0.013	1
143-2879	9.5 10.5	36	1	1/2	Taper	1.432	0.039	1
153-5721	15.4 16.6	36	1	1/2	Taper	1.432	0.039	1
247-4944	9.5 10.5	18	0					12
167-3781	15.4 16.6	18	0					12
167-3782	9.5 10.5	27	1	1/2	Taper	0.884	0.034	1
167-3783	7.5 8.5	27	1	1/2	Taper	0.687	0.017	1
167-3784	5.5 6.5	8	2	1/4	Spatula	0.320	0.014	1
176-6186	12.5 13.5	18	0					12
208-5946	18.4 19.6	36	1	1/2	Taper	1.890	0.050	1

Sutures shall be sterile in accordance with the USP. Sutures shall have at least 50 months of the original shelf-life remaining at the time of delivery to the Government. Sutures shall be packaged sterile inside an inner container made of aluminum foil and/or plastic. The inner container shall be packaged sterile inside an outer container of the peel-back opening type as shown in Figure 1. The inner container shall show no evidence of leakage when tested as specified in ASTM D3078. Inner and outer containers shall maintain sterility throughout the shelf-life. Each inner container shall have a label identifying the suture material, size, length, number of arms, needle circle, needle point, and the legend "sterile."

Workmanship. Sutures shall be free from frays and other defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability. Needles shall be bright and smooth, and free of feathered edges; cracks, burs, and other defects.

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Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 36 individually packaged single-armed sutures, or 12 individually packaged double-armed sutures, or 144 unarmed sutures, packed 12 to a packet, or 432 unarmed sutures packed 12 to a packet, of one size only, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-1 and acceptance number zero. Sampling for sterility shall be in accordance with the USP. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one suture.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-231-3635	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 7-0, Double-Armed, 12s
6515-01-231-7236	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 4-0, Single-Armed, 36s
6515-01-230-3079	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 2-0, Single-Armed, 36s
6515-01-237-0530	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 4-0, Single Armed, 36s
6515-01-231-8123	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 2-0, Single Armed, 12s

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NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-233-1888	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 0, Single-Armed, 12s
6515-01-231-3636	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 2-0, Single-Armed, 12s
6515-01-233-1887	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 0, Single-Armed, 12s
6515-01-153-5898	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 6-0, Double-Armed, 12s
6515-01-143-2879	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 3-0, Single-Armed, 36s
6515-01-153-5721	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 0, Single-Armed, 36s
6515-01-247-4944	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 3-0, Unarmed, 24s
6515-01-167-3781	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 0, Unarmed, 12s
6515-01-167-3782	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 3-0, Single-Armed, 36s
6515-01-167-3783	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 4-0, Single-Armed, 36s
6515-01-167-3784	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 5-0, Double-Armed, 12s
6515-01-176-6186	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 1-0, Unarmed, 36s
6515-01-208-5946	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer, Size 1-0, Single-Armed, 36s

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Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-3924

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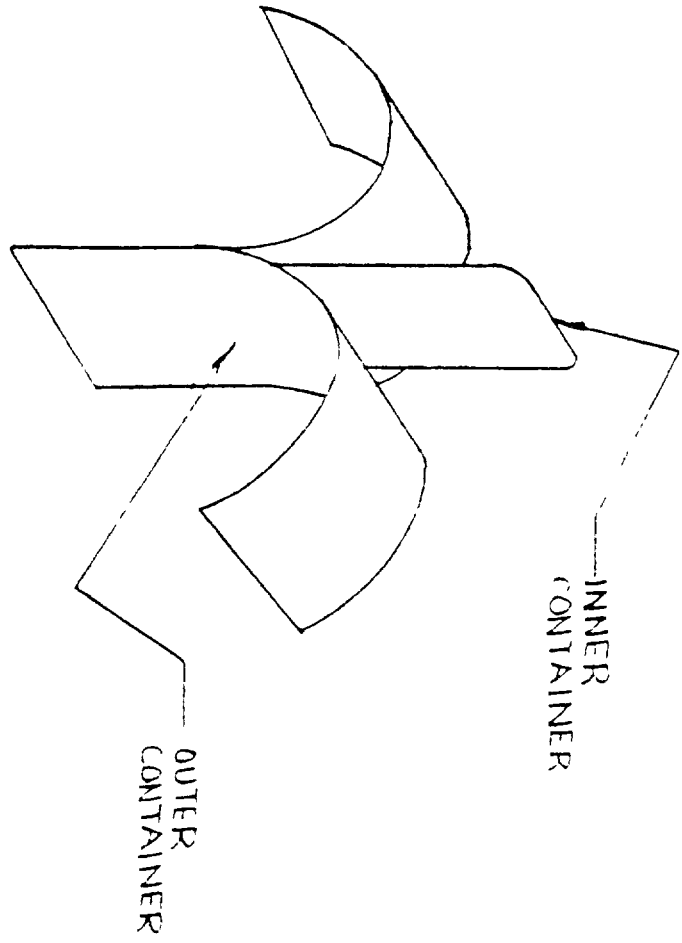


FIGURE 1

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51612A	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL (Glycolide-Lactide Copolymer)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording.

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* - Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* - Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* - Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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